

6.1 Buyers

Users planning to use GCK for their purchases need to provide a credit card number, besides a residential address, at the time of signup. There are no fees associated with using GCK for purchasing online. GCK keeps track of all the transactions conducted by a user, so a purchase history is easily available. GCK does not reveal card details to merchants, and if the user so desires, even the e-mail ID is withheld. Also, it allows users to rate the merchants they purchased from. This rating is maintained independent of the merchant's site, and so allows other users to form unbiased opinions. GCK offers the user protection from credit card theft in case unauthorised purchases are made on the credit card.

6.2 Merchants

Merchants who want to offer the service are provided with JavaScript code that needs to be inserted into their site. The link provided in the code takes a visitor to the GCK page, where the details of the payment are to be filled out. GCK charges \$0.20 plus 2 per cent of the transaction value as fees. By offering discounts to member of its AdWords programme, Google offers some incentive to sign up for GCK. An investment in AdWords allows free transactions up to ten times that in GCK. So a merchant who's invested \$10 in AdWords is not levied any transaction fees for transactions of up to \$100. Other ways in which GCK helps merchants is by putting up an icon in their ads. People who can see the GCK icon in the site's ads can be assured that GCK is providing the payment service. This helps the GCK-supported site's ads to stand apart from other ads. Besides that, GCK helps merchants fight buyer fraud, a situation where buyers claim that the product they received is not as described.